of early Nehruvianism, wedded to Fabian socialism, suspicion of the West, and non-alignment.

Manmohan Singh laid out what Indian analyst, C. Raja Mohan, described as the Manmohan Singh doctrine in speeches at the *Hindustan Times* Leadership Initiative Conference on 5 November 2004 and at the *India Today* Conclave on 25 February 2005. According to this doctrine the 'single most important objective' of Indian foreign policy was to 'create a global environment conducive to her economic development and the well-being of the people of India'. India sought 'greater integration with the world economy' especially with those in Asia. India's ties with major powers would be shaped by economic factors and especially energy security. India championed greater regional cooperation and deeper physical connectivity within South Asia. Like his predecessors, Manmohan also saw India as an example to the world of a country that pursued economic growth and yet remained a plural, secular and liberal democracy. India also had a 'global responsibility to assist societies in transition'.[134]

Nehruvian idealism was visible when at an annual conference of Indian diplomats Manmohan Singh asserted, 'Foreign policy is not defined merely by our interests, but also by the values which are very dear to our people. India's experiment of pursuing economic development within the framework of a plural, secular and liberal democracy has inspired people around the world.'[135] For Manmohan, as for every prime minister before him, the key priority was ensuring that India secured the requisite space to grow economically and occupy its place under the sun. But after the pragmatic approaches of Narasimha Rao and Atal Bihari Vajpayee, India's new prime minister reverted to idealistic proclamations on certain issues as a substitute for hard-nosed policy choices.

Nehru had emphasized the importance of economic foreign policy but it was only from Rajiv Gandhi onwards that Indian leaders really focused on this issue. As prime minister, Manmohan Singh carried this view forward,